

# PowerShell for QA

Microsoft shell and automation language useful for setup, execution and project administration.

## PowerShell vs CMD vs VS Code

PowerShell and CMD are Windows shells. VS Code is an editor that can host them in its integrated terminal.

## Navigation

Get-Location, Get-ChildItem and Set-Location navigate the filesystem; aliases such as pwd, ls and cd are common.

## Environment variables

Use \$env:NAME="value" for the current session, useful for test credentials without hardcoding.

## Python and venv

Activate virtual environments and run pip, pytest and Playwright directly in PowerShell.

## Git

git status, add, commit, pull and push work normally once Git is installed and available on PATH.

## Automation

PowerShell can automate repetitive tasks, manipulate files and integrate system commands.

## QA tip

■■ QA Tip: know which shell you are using before copying commands; environment-variable syntax differs.

## Official resources

Site oficial: <https://learn.microsoft.com/powershell/>